

THE GARAMUT



A MESSAGE SENDER

*Ps Barry's
Reflections on:*
**PRAYER,
PROCLAMATION and
PERSONAL PROGRESS**

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THE THEME FOR OUR STUDY TODAY IS THE WORD RUN – OR RUNNING

- * To run is not walking – not dawdling - not taking our time, not delaying and not procrastinating.
- * To run means that there is **no room or time** to **hesitate** or to **cautiously** proceed.
- * To run is an **action** word requiring speed, promptness and quickness.

RUNNING THE RACE

Hebrews 12:1 Therefore, since we are surrounded by such a great cloud of witnesses, we must get rid of every weight and the sin that clings so closely, and run with endurance the race set out for us, NET
Hebrews 12:1 "...and let us run with patient endurance and steady and active persistence the appointed course of the race that is set before us", AMP

Hebrews 12:1 ".....and let us run with perseverance the race marked out for us". NIV

- * Yes, we are commanded to run with **endurance**, **persistence** and **patience** but that is SECONDARY and not primary and only describes the requirements of the run.
- * IT DOES NOT DESCRIBE WHAT RUNNING ACTUALLY MEANS IN.
- * The PRIMARY thing is, that we are actually **ENGAGED in RUNNING** in the ways of God's commands.
- * This is the first condition of the command in Hebrews 12. Yes it states that we are to Run with **endurance, persistence and patience** but these are secondary to running.
- * **Running is PRIMARY, it comes first.**
- * To run is the primary demand, it is the action that is required – where speed, quickness, promptness and haste are expressed.
- * While expressing all that running implies we are then given the environment or conditions that define how we are to run.

ELIJAH'S CHALLENGE to God's people is still relevant for us today.

- *1 Kings 18:21 And Elijah came unto all the people, and said, **How long halt ye between two opinions?** KJV*
- *"How much longer will you waver, hobbling between two opinions? NLT*
- *"How long are you going to sit on the fence? **"Make up your minds!"** The Message*
- * HOW LONG WILL WE HALT OR WAVER BETWEEN TWO OPINIONS WHEN THE LORD HAS ALREADY COMMANDED US?
- * WHY CAN'T WE MAKE UP OUR MIND TO DO WHAT GOD SAID?
- * WHY IS IT THAT WE CAN'T FOLLOW THE GENERAL COMMANDS THAT JESUS GAVE US?
- * WHY MUST WE WAIT FOR SOME PERSONAL COMMAND like a prophetic word, vision, dream or encounter with the Lord BEFORE WE RUN?
- * WHERE IS OUR SPONTANEITY TO RESPOND?
- * **RUNNING IS THE SPONTANEOUS RESPONSE OF A WILLING HEART**, a heart that has already made commitment to run after the commands of the Master.

RUNNING IN THE WAY OF GOD'S COMMANDMENTS.

Psalms 119: 32 I will run in the way of thy commandments NET

- * Which means I am quick and very committed to obeying what God commands expressing that eagerness by the action of running.
- * Are we expressing the action of running in our personal response to what Jesus has commanded his disciples?

Example: In going instead of staying home, in forgiving instead of allowing offences and hurts to linger on unattended, or in trusting instead of doubting and hesitancy etc?

I WILL RUN AFTER YOU

Song of Solomon 1:4 Draw me, we will run after thee: AMP & KJV

- * This lady is stating her passionate desire to her lover that IF HE DRAWS HER she WILL RUN AFTER him.
- * IF MY LOVER is the one who is leading me I will be QUICK to follow = to run after him.
[Note: The bride is a type of the Church and the Bridegroom a type of Jesus].
- * She is stating that she has INWARDLY POSITIONED HER HEART TO RUN AFTER HIM when he invites or indicates the direction to follow.

QUESTION: ARE WE LIKE THAT?

- HAVE WE POSITIONED OUR HEARTS TO ATTEMPT TO RUN AFTER OUR JESUS?
- CAN WE SAY 'I WILL RUN AFTER YOU'?
- ARE WE DAILY DESIRING, PRAYING FOR OUR LORD TO DRAW US?
- ARE WE HUNGRY FOR his leading and direction for our lives?

THE LORD'S BUSINESS REQUIRES HASTE – IT IS URGENT IT CANNOT WAIT

- 1 Samuel 21:8 “.....The king's business required haste, and AMP
- 1 Samuel 21:8 “.....because the king's business required haste.” ESV
- 1 Samuel 21:8 “...because the king's business was urgent.” NIV
- * WE MUST NOT DELAY OR HESITATE IN DOING GOD'S BUSINESS; HIS WORK MUST TAKE PRIORITY OVER OTHER THINGS.

QUESTION:

- LET US MAKE A FRESH COMMITMENT TO BE MORE SPONTANEOUS IN OUR RUNNING TO DO GOD'S WORK even though we may be tired or frustrated with the things we have experienced over the past year.

THE RUNNING OF ELISHA.

- * ELISHA RUNNING AFTER THE PROPHET ELIJAH after Elijah casts his mantle /cloak (a figure of his anointing as a prophet) to be a prophet on Elisha.
- * ELISHA'S IMMEDIATE RESPONSE TO THE CALL OF GOD ON HIS LIFE.
- * HE RAN AFTER ELIJAH TO ASSURE HIM OF HIS INTENTION AND READINESS TO STARTING SERVING GOD.

1 Kings 19:20 And he left the oxen, and ran after Elijah, and said, Let me, I pray thee, kiss my father and my mother, and then I will follow thee. And he said unto him, Go back again: for what have I done to thee? KJV
1 Kings 19:20 Elisha deserted the oxen, ran after Elijah, and said, "Please! Let me kiss my father and mother good-bye — then I'll follow you." "Go ahead," said Elijah, "but, mind you, don't forget what I've just done to you." The Message

- * THAT “RUNNING” FACTOR THAT WAS ONCE IN OUR LIVES IMMEDIATELY AFTER WE WERE SAVED AND CALLED BY GOD AND HOW VITALLY IMPORTANT, IT WAS TO GOD AND ALSO FOR OUR SPIRITUAL DEVELOPMENT.

QUESTION:

- * IS THERE A NEED FOR US TO RENEW THAT VIGOUR AND SPEEDINESS OF HEART WITHIN US ONCE AGAIN? DO WE NEED TO REDISCOVER HOW TO RUN AGAIN?
- * IT IS AN ATTITUDE MATTER AND WE CAN ALL DETERMINE THE KIND OF ATTITUDE THAT WE WANT TO HAVE AND MAINTAIN IN OUR SERVICE FOR GOD.

Amen – Ps Barry